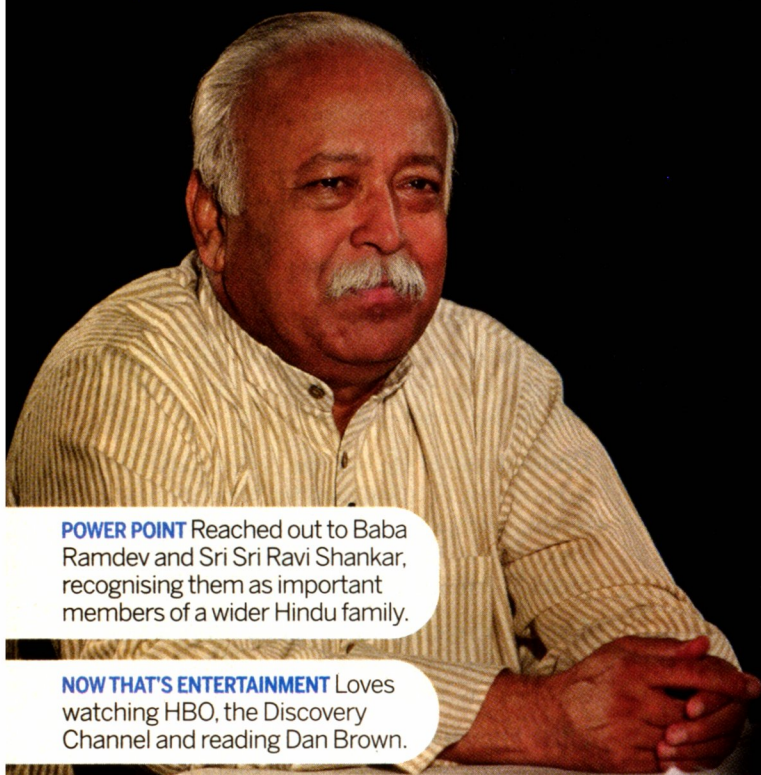


7

MOHANRAO BHAGWAT

59, RSS Chief (Sarsanghchalak) (New)



POWER POINT Reached out to Baba Ramdev and Sri Sri Ravi Shankar, recognising them as important members of a wider Hindu family.

NOW THAT'S ENTERTAINMENT Loves watching HBO, the Discovery Channel and reading Dan Brown.

Fundamentally Right

Because he has re-established the supremacy of the RSS over the BJP.

Because soon after he said that no one from Delhi would be the next BJP chief, the party brought in the Maharashtra-based Nitin Gadkari as its new supremo.

Because after he announced that the leadership age should not exceed 60, the octogenarian L.K. Advani stepped down as the Leader of Opposition.

Because he is the modern face of a deeply conservative organisation, switching from shorts at an RSS shakha to a dapper suit and tie for a Swedish Embassy lunch to meet European Union leaders.

Because he has never made a hate speech against any other religion though he insists the BJP will not compromise on its core issue.

Smart move Told the BJP to oppose its ally Shiv Sena's diatribe against non-Maharashtrians, reinforcing the Sangh Parivar's strong commitment to national integration.

The modernist Prefers power point presentations at meetings and has reduced the average age of pracharaks from 50 to 35-40.

The coincidence The man chosen by the RSS to revive the right wing looks a lot like Keshav Baliram Hedgewar, the founder of RSS.

8

AHMED PATEL

60, Political Adviser to the Congress President (9)

Backroom Baron

Because he is the one person whose advice the Congress president cannot do without.

Because apart from Sonia Gandhi, he is the only non-Cabinet member of the all-powerful Congress core committee.

Because whenever there is a crisis in Parliament, whether it is over the Women's Reservation Bill or the Sharm el-Sheikh fiasco, he does the backroom firefighting.

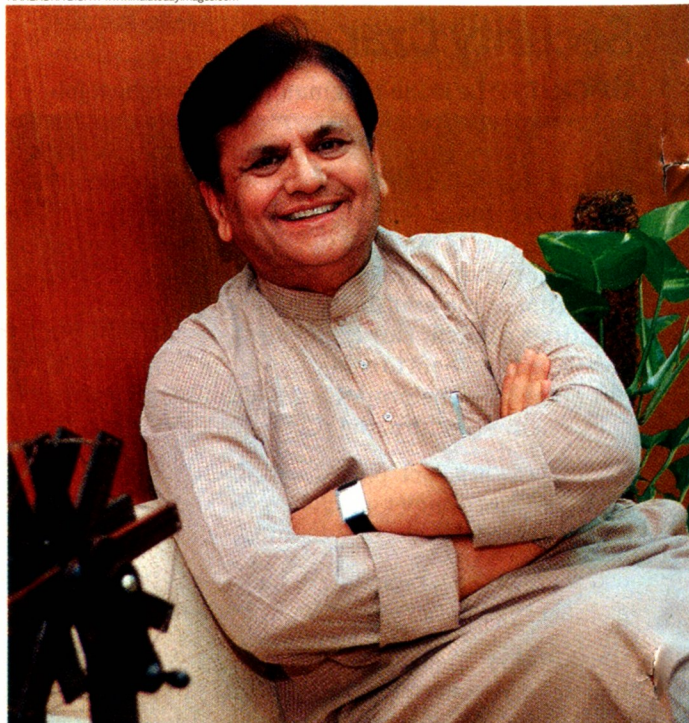
Because whenever Sonia holds a crucial meeting at 10 Janpath, whether on Telangana or the Maharashtra seat-sharing issue, Patel is present there as well.

Smart move Always makes a discreet exit even if he is leaving after a regular day in Parliament. Avoids the media, except when it's for an off-the-record briefing.

Cherished moment Scored a hundred during a Parliament cricket match in 1977. Even though he was a Lok Sabha MP, he batted for the Rajya Sabha. Still has the picture of Indira Gandhi giving him the award.

The aura His friends call him Ahmed Bhai. His detractors simply call him 'The Bhai'.

NARENDRA BISHT/www.indiatodayimages.com



THE LOOK Keeps it simple. Usually sports coloured kurtas, drives a grey Esteem and wears a Titan watch.

POWER MOVE Always sets his watch 15 minutes ahead of real time. That's one way of staying ahead.